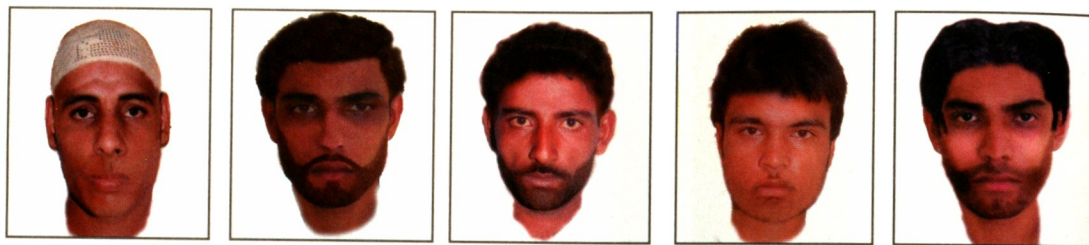


COVER STORY **TERRORISM**



MASTERMINDS: Five sketches of the blast suspects which were released by the Delhi Police directly under the Union Home Ministry. "We have a problem here; there is no proper dissemination of intelligence inputs. The situation is much worse elsewhere," concedes a senior cop in the Delhi Police, dealing with special crimes. Preliminary investigations in the Delhi serial blasts bear the IM signature: the use of local, disillusioned and tech-savvy Muslims to carry out the attacks. Abdul Subhan Qureshi alias Tauqeer is said to be the mastermind behind the latest strikes in Delhi.

The terrorists used LOCALS to execute the SERIAL blasts using easily available substances like FERTILISERS and TNT.

However, the modus operandi has changed a lot from the time Islamic terror first arrived in the Capital some 12 years ago when the busy Central Market in Lajpat Nagar was rocked by explosions on the evening of May 21, 1996. The blast had claimed 13 lives and left 39 injured.

With every subsequent attack, the terror mongers grew bolder; their next target was the Delhi Police Headquarters, in January 1997. Then, between October and December 1997, six separate blasts were carried out in the Capital at different places starting from the wholesale market in Sadar Bazar where 16 were injured and nine days later, one was killed and 16 others were injured in three bomb blasts in the Shantivan, Kauria Pul and Kingsway Camp areas. This was followed a week later by twin blasts in the Rani Bagh market where one person died and 23 were hurt. Then two twin

blasts happened in Rani Bagh and Red Fort area over a span of four days, killing 12 and injuring about 100. A month later, four people were killed and more than 100 injured in a bomb explosion on a bus near Punjabi

The Red Fort area again on the terror spree. An attack on the highway near the fort was carried out on December 22, 2001. On December 13, 2001, the Indian democracy, the Parliament was attacked which claimed seven lives. Four people died and 70 injured in busy markets—Sadar

The present series of attacks using easily available fertilisers (ammonium nitrate) of ammonium nitrate capabilities, in places, it inflicts heavy continual intelligence terror attacks, the

*Times change.
Commitments don't.*

